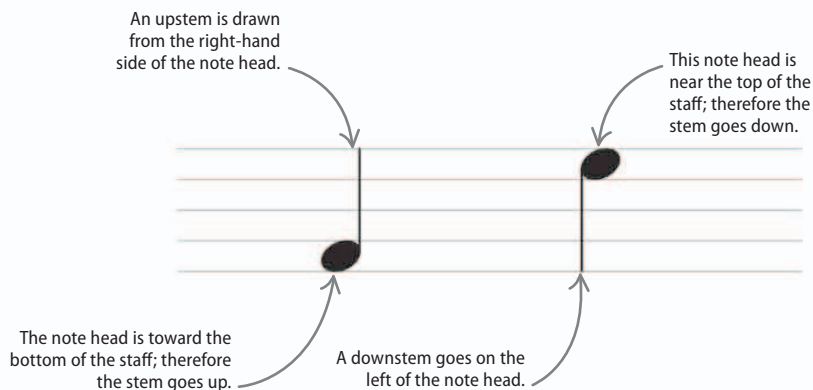


Stems and note heads

Most notes in the top half of the staff have downstems, and notes in the bottom half have upstems, but there are many exceptions to this, for instance when two lines of music are written on the same staff.



Practicing writing notes

You can buy books of blank manuscript paper, useful for practicing writing notes and other musical elements such as clefs.



△ Note with upstem

Draw the notehead carefully in the space, or on the line, as desired. Then, for a low note like this one, add an upstem, starting on the right-hand edge of the note head.

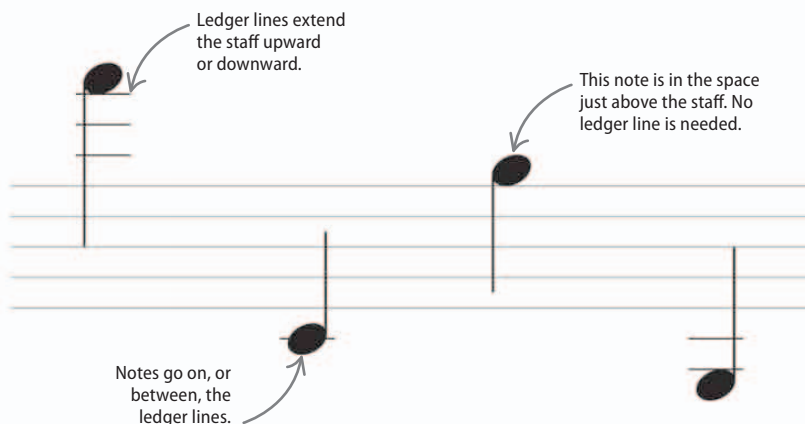


△ Note on the middle line

By convention, a note on the middle line has a downstem. Draw the note head first, then a downstem starting on the left-hand edge.

Ledger lines

With its five lines and four spaces, the staff covers just a little over an octave. However, it can be extended, upward or downward, by adding short lines called ledger lines. Notes can be placed on these lines, or in the spaces, in exactly the same way as on the staff.



▷ How many ledger lines can you add?

Theoretically, there is no limit to the number of ledger lines that can be added, but in practice they can become difficult to read if there are more than about four ledger lines.